

Steel & Might — Open Rules Questions

Version 3 — 2026-06-12. After the rulebook pass, Andrei's answers, and the old guide's recovery of the races, exhaustion and carry rules, ~33 of the original 49 questions are settled. These 15 remain.

NEEDS ANSWER = part of the engine stays unbuilt until answered. **DEFAULT ASSUMED** = we build the stated assumption; speak up only if wrong.

Clarifiers on the new designs

N9 Stack thresholds — consumption **NEEDS ANSWER**

Confirmed: stacks accumulate, and reaching the threshold applies the effect for 1 round (5 stun stacks vs threshold 4 → stunned 1 round). One detail: are the threshold's worth of stacks **consumed** by the trigger (5 – 4 = 1 stack remains, per the Guide pp.8–9), or do all 5 persist until a rest clears them?

Answer: _____

N10 Stack thresholds — which rest clears stacks? **NEEDS ANSWER**

Accumulated stacks dissipate on rests — short rest, long rest, or both (perhaps depending on the long-rest tier)?

Answer: _____

N11 Death — four details **NEEDS ANSWER**

Confirmed design: at 0 HP, downed for WILL-modifier rounds (WILL mod ≤ 0 = death outright); the dying fight Death to be revivable; beating Death adds a Death Stack that empowers Death next time; teammates can help up the downed. Four details: **(a)** if the downed countdown runs out without help, does the Death fight begin then? **(b)** What does "helping up" cost/do — AP, a check, how much HP do they come back with? **(c)** Is the Death fight run by the DM narratively, or should the sheet track it (old guide says it's fought "with full resources")? **(d)** Do Death Stacks affect the living character at all, or only empower Death?

Answer: _____

Q20 Long-rest tiers **NEEDS ANSWER**

Confirmed: long rests are tiered; short rests restore HP only, from a pool equal to what the last long rest restored; resources restore a tier-dependent %, with fractional charges resolved as guaranteed floor + probability roll. Remaining: **what determines the tier** (location? comfort? supplies?), **what % each tier restores**, and does HP restoration follow the same percentage?

Answer: _____

Old guide → current rules: please confirm

Q33 Carry capacity **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

The old guide says: **inventory limit** = $10 + 2 \times \text{STR modifier}$. Still current? And what happens when over the limit?

ASSUMPTION: formula is current; going over is simply prevented.

Answer: _____

N13 Movement speeds — odd halves **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Old-guide speeds (per 2 AP) halved to the new per-AP convention give clean numbers for most races (30→15, 40→20), but: Dwarf/Gnome/Dwurgo/Kraka/Triton 25→**12.5** and Stoneborn/Minotaur/Oni 35→**17.5**. Keep the halves, or have these been rebalanced to whole numbers?

ASSUMPTION: halves kept as-is for now.

Answer: _____

N14 Three racial skills don't exist anymore **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Centaur grants **Nature**, Minotaur grants **Memory**, Orc grants **Resolve** — none are among the current 19 skill checks. Map them to current skills (which?), or add them to the skill list? (Sleight of Hand was already mapped to Thievery.)

ASSUMPTION: kept under old names, flagged, until mapped.

Answer: _____

N15 Bergs **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

The old guide has a 22nd race — Bergs, underground burrowers (burrow speed, piercing resistance, Unburrow attack) — that isn't in the current roster. In or out?

ASSUMPTION: out.

Answer: _____

N16 Saving throws: per subclass or per class? **NEEDS ANSWER**

The old guide lists saving-throw proficiencies **per subclass**, and they differ within a class (Bard dex/cha, Virtuoso int/cha, Minstrel will/cha). Our current data has them per parent class. Which is right? (If per subclass: the old list omits Spirit Master — what are theirs?)

Answer: _____

N17 Racial level-1 stats **NEEDS ANSWER**

Each race lists "the stats that can be increased at level 1" (e.g. Human: STR, DEX, WILL, CHA). Is this still current — and does it mean the +5 creation bonus points may only go into those 4 stats?

Answer: _____

Carried over from v2

Q2 Haste & "slow effects" **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Which effects does Haste cleanse? Should "Slowed" become a defined condition (the term already appears informally, e.g. Eniyan Overdrive's aftermath)?

ASSUMPTION: Haste cleanses nothing until defined.

Answer: _____

Q7 Wounded vs armor order **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Wounded's bonus damage on direct attacks — added before or after armor reduction?

ASSUMPTION: after armor (always lands in full).

Answer: _____

Q8 Magic Shield vs temporary HP **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

With both active, which absorbs magical damage first?

ASSUMPTION: Magic Shield first.

Answer: _____

Q10 Decaying **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

"Healing effects deal damage instead" — what damage type, and does armor reduce it?

ASSUMPTION: pure damage, ignores armor.

Answer: _____

Q11 Healing the downed **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

With the new death rules: does healing a downed character during their WILL-modifier countdown bring them back up directly?

ASSUMPTION: yes — healing above 0 HP ends the downed state.

Answer: _____

Q13 Start-of-turn ordering **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Burning/poison ticks vs AP recovery — which first? If the first tick downs the character, do the rest still tick?

ASSUMPTION: damage first; all ticks resolve.

Answer: _____

Q18 AP outside combat **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

AP simply resets to starting (6) at every combat start, and rests don't interact with it — correct?

ASSUMPTION: yes.

Answer: _____

Q29 Equipment slots **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Confirmed: dual-wield via the *light* property. Remaining: shield + two-handed strictly impossible (outside the Cannon Shield)? Can a weapon and a caster weapon both be ready? AP cost to swap/draw?

ASSUMPTION: two-handed blocks shield; one weapon set ready; swapping free.

Answer: _____

Q32 Tool proficiencies **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

How are tool proficiencies (smith's tools etc.) acquired, and is there a list?

ASSUMPTION: upgrade rolls assume no proficiency until defined. (Note: Dwarves get upgrade-kit proficiency racially per the old guide.)

Answer: _____

Q34 Durability **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Durability is referenced (kits replenish it; damaged items sell lower) but has no numbers. Track it on the sheet, or leave to the table?

ASSUMPTION: not tracked.

Answer: _____

N2 Monster "might" **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

Concentration-break saves use $DC = 5 + \text{attacker's might}$. The DM enters might with each damage event on the sheet — right? Typical range?

ASSUMPTION: DM supplies it per attack.

Answer: _____

N5 Healing potions **DEFAULT ASSUMED**

A potion heals $\text{size factor} \times \text{the potion's own level}$ (a level-10 Small potion heals 50 for anyone) — correct?

ASSUMPTION: yes — potion level, not drinker level.

Answer: _____

Settled since v2: stack-threshold system confirmed (accumulate $\rightarrow$ threshold $\text{ceil}(\text{level}/2) \rightarrow$ effect for 1 round; stacks clear on rests); death rules designed (downed WILL-mod rounds ; $\text{WILL} \leq 0$ dies; fight Death to revive;

Death Stacks empower Death); short rest = HP only from a last-LR-sized pool; long rests are tiered; stat increases = +5 (max 2/stat); HP rises with max on level-up; Specialist class is in; tables beat prose; all 21 missing races recovered from the old guide (incl. resistances, speeds, proficiencies); Exhaustion fully defined (6-stack ladder ending in death); carry formula found ($10 + 2 \times \text{STR mod}$, pending confirmation above).